

Watershed ArcGIS StoryMap Bootcamp

Bootcamp Structure

5 lessons, 1 per week, 45-60 minutes per lesson, hosted on Zoom.

Weekly Structure

- Lesson 1: Understanding the topic and the tools
- Lesson 2: Building the maps
- Lesson 3: Creating the StoryMap
- Lesson 4: Write findings, draft policy recommendation, publish the URL
- Lesson 5: Symposium

Materials Needed

- Before class, complete the instructions on the PDF we will send out, including ArcGIS account creation information.
- Computer
- Stable internet connection
- Pencil/pen and paper

Lesson 1: Understanding the topic and the tools

In class

- Begin with bootcamp overview: over the next 4 classes, students will investigate a real environmental problem in their local community, use mapping software, build computational/data skills, and publish a platform of findings to present to a panel at the symposium.
- Introductions of coaches.
- Introduction of ArcGIS.
- Briefly go over the 2 parts students will use: Map Viewer and StoryMaps.
- Present the deliverables and skills students will gain.
- Build a research question: strong vs. weak questions, with examples.
- Give students 5 minutes to write down 2-3 candidate research questions for practice, then have some students share.
- Practice activity: students experiment with ArcGIS by typing in their school/neighborhood and exploring the features.
- Wrap up and introduce homework before the next lesson.

Homework

- Finalize 1 research question in 1 sentence, then elaborate: what place is it specific to, can ArcGIS data answer it, and what would that answer do?
- Explore ArcGIS and think about what aspects of this problem you want to present or learn more about.

Lesson 2: Building the maps

In class

- Share research questions from last class.
- Give feedback on specificity and ask what data students would need.
- Give the class 2-3 minutes to finalize their questions.
- Explain what a map layer is and why it matters, so students understand why they are adding layers.
- Add the 1st layer: boundary of the area being studied to focus the map.
- Add the core data layer that helps answer the research question.
- Experiment by adding other layers, changing colors, and adjusting the map.
- Save the map.

Homework

- Finish the map that will be used, experiment, and add more layers.
- Write 3 main observations from the current map.
- Write a paragraph attempting to answer the research question from the map.

Lesson 3: Creating the StoryMap

In class

- Have 2-3 students share their maps.
- Make sure the boundary is visible, the core data layer is styled clearly, and the map is meaningful.
- Go over what a StoryMap is: a platform that takes your map and surrounds it with other visuals and analysis to turn it into a story or argument.
- Get used to the platform and show examples.
- Go over the essentials: the problem, research question, data/maps, what students found, and the recommendation.
- Embed the maps.
- Independent work time: students should leave class with a draft of the StoryMap and a finished outline.

Homework

- Finish the StoryMap.
- Read through the map to make sure it is not confusing.
- If emailed to us 2 days before Class 4, we can give feedback before the lesson.

Lesson 4: Write findings, draft policy recommendation, publish the URL

In class

- Have 2-3 students share their StoryMap.
- Revision time and questions.
- Sharpen the policy recommendation: specific person/body, action, location, and because our data shows finding.
- Add data sources.
- Publish the URL.
- Prepare for symposium presentation.

Homework

- Prepare for symposium presentation and make final touches.

Lesson 5: Symposium

In class

- Students present their published StoryMap URL and findings at the symposium.

Homework

No homework listed for the symposium.